

Equivalent Expression Maze

Unit 6: Music Studio • Lesson 6-6 • EduWonderLab

UNIT 6 • LESSON 6-6 • TEACHER NOTES

Standard 6.EE.4

FORMAT Self-checking maze

TIME 25–30 min

GROUPING Solo or pairs

TOPIC Equivalent Expressions

STANDARD 6.EE.4

PREP LEVEL Light — print maze sheet and expression cards

Learning goal *I can simplify expressions and identify equivalent expressions.*

Teacher setup

- Print one maze per student. Students simplify each expression and follow only the equivalent path.
- Dead ends contain common mistakes.
- Require work shown beside each turn.

Materials

Maze sheet, Expression cards, Like-term color guide, Pencil.

Differentiation & language support

- Color guide groups like terms by variable (SPED).
- Sentence stem: “___ is equivalent to ___ because ___.”
- ESOL: keep one worked simplification visible.

Key vocabulary (English / Español):

Term	Español	What it means
equivalent	equivalente	equal for every value
like terms	términos semejantes	terms with the same variable

Quick teacher check: *Ask a student to substitute $x = 2$ to test one equivalent pair.*

Equivalent Expression Maze

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Name: _____

Date: _____

Class: _____

Your goal: *I can simplify expressions and identify equivalent expressions.*

What you need

Maze sheet, Expression cards.

How to play

1. Start at the first box and simplify the expression.
2. Find the box with the equivalent expression.
3. Show your work beside each turn.
4. Follow the equivalent path to the finish.

Maze Steps

Simplify each expression. Move only to the box that is equivalent.

1. $2x + 3x$	2. $4x - x$
3. $x + x + x$	4. $5x + 2 - 2x$
5. $3(x + 2)$	6. $6x + 4 - 4$
7. $2(2x + 1)$	8. $7x - 3x + x$

Record your work (simplify each step):

Explain your thinking

Explain how you can test whether two expressions are equivalent.

Sentence frame: ___ is equivalent to ___ because they have the same value for every ___.

★ **Challenge:** Cards 1 and 8 both simplify to $5x$. Write a third expression that also equals $5x$.

ANSWER KEY

Teacher copy — please do not distribute to students.

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Answers

1. $2x + 3x$ Answer: $5x$	2. $4x - x$ Answer: $3x$
3. $x + x + x$ Answer: $3x$	4. $5x + 2 - 2x$ Answer: $3x + 2$
5. $3(x + 2)$ Answer: $3x + 6$	6. $6x + 4 - 4$ Answer: $6x$
7. $2(2x + 1)$ Answer: $4x + 2$	8. $7x - 3x + x$ Answer: $5x$

Teaching notes & look-fors

- Two expressions are equivalent if they give the same value for every variable value.
- Cards 1, 8 $\rightarrow 5x$. Substituting a number is a quick test.